

Changes in Reported Speech

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

In reported speech, three kinds of words shift to fit the new context:

- 1 Pronouns/possessives — 'I like your car' → He said he liked my car.
- 2 Time words — now → then, today → that day, tomorrow → the next day.
- 3 Place & demonstratives — here → there, this → that, these → those.

Only shift when the situation has changed. If you report on the same day, 'today' can stay; if later, it becomes 'that day'.

At a glance

Original	Reported
I, we, you	he/she/they, I/we (as needed)
my, your, our	his/her, my, their
now	then
today	that day
tomorrow	the next day
yesterday	the day before
last week	the week before
here	there
this / these	that / those

Learning objectives

- Can shift pronouns and possessives to the new speaker in reported speech (CEFR B1).
- Can convert time references (now/today/tomorrow/yesterday) correctly.
- Can shift place and demonstratives (here/this/these).

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. the next day** — 'Tomorrow' shifts to 'the next day'.
2. **A. the day before** — 'Yesterday' shifts to 'the day before'.
3. **A. my** — Speaking to me, 'your' becomes 'my'.
4. **A. then** — 'Now' shifts to 'then'.
5. **A. there** — 'Here' shifts to 'there'.
6. **A. those** — 'These' shifts to 'those'.
7. **A. today** — Reporting on the same day, 'today' can stay.
8. **A. the week before** — 'Last week' shifts to 'the week before'.
9. **A. She said she liked that restaurant there.** — 'This ... here' shifts to 'that ... there'.
10. **A. then** — 'Now' → 'then'.